

Career Clinic - Strategy and Launch Plan

Career Clinic — Strategy, Structure & Launch Plan

1. What Career Clinic Is

Career Clinic is a cohort-based career advancement program for immigrant professionals who are already employed in Canada but stuck — underpaid, underleveraged, and invisible relative to their actual experience. It teaches the parts of career growth that are never written down anywhere: how to build credibility, get seen, and get promoted inside a Canadian organization. Where every other program in this space stops at “get hired,” Career Clinic starts there.

2. Who It’s For

Primary ICP: The Employed-But-Stuck Professional

- Foreign-trained professional (finance, IT, engineering, business, healthcare-adjacent), degree or equivalent credential
- 28–45 years old, 2–10 years in Canada
- Currently employed — but in a role below their experience level, or plateaued with no visibility or promotion path
- Financially stable enough to invest in themselves
- Has already tried the free, entry-level settlement services (resume help, first-job coaching) — those solved the “get hired” problem but have nothing for what comes next

This is a deliberately narrow ICP, and that’s the point: it’s the one segment almost nobody is building for. Free settlement agencies (Centre for Newcomers, CIWA, ISSofBC, OCISO) and most paid coaches are built to get someone their *first* Canadian job. Nobody is teaching the internal game — visibility, trust, sponsorship, promotion — which is exactly the gap this program fills.

3. The Problem (data-backed)

- Only 44% of immigrants who arrived in Canada in the past decade work in jobs matching their education level, versus 64% of Canadian-born workers aged 25–34.
- The over-education rate for immigrant degree-holders is roughly 25–27%, more than double the ~11% rate for Canadian-born workers with equivalent credentials.
- Even immigrants whose jobs formally match their education are more likely to work outside their specific area of expertise — a quieter, harder-to-name form of being stuck.
- Underutilizing immigrants’ skills is estimated to cost the Canadian economy \$12.7–17 billion a year in lost earnings. This is a systemic, documented pattern — not a personal failing.
- The barriers are structural: employer bias toward “Canadian experience” (illegal to require in Ontario, but a persistent de facto filter), referral networks that exclude newcomers, and hiring managers who don’t know how to evaluate foreign credentials or experience.

The honest framing for this ICP specifically: it’s not that they can’t get hired — they did. It’s that once inside, nobody taught them the unwritten rules of how credibility, visibility, and advancement actually work in a Canadian workplace, so their careers stall exactly at the point everyone assumes the hard part is over.

4. Value Proposition

Career Clinic is the only program built for immigrant professionals who already got the job — and now need the insider playbook for visibility, trust, and promotion inside a Canadian organization. Everyone else stops at “get hired.” We start where they stop.

Competitor type	Strength	Gap this program fills
Free settlement agencies	Free, credible, good for job #1	Nothing for people already employed and stalled
High-ticket “hype” coaches	Bold marketing, fast-hire stories	Transactional, no community, no advancement content
Self-paced courses	Cheap, flexible	No live coaching, no accountability, no network
Career Clinic	Cohort + community + live mentorship + advancement content no one else offers, plus a done-for-you top tier	—

A note on expectations

The program teaches the skills, systems, and support for advancement. It does not guarantee a promotion, raise, or new role — promotion decisions involve factors outside any program’s control (org budget, headcount, manager discretion, timing). The claim to make consistently is about what participants *build* (a case for advancement, visibility, a network, negotiation skill), not what will happen to them. This distinction should carry through every piece of marketing copy, the landing page, and any outcome data published later.

Tiers

Tier 1 — Foundation: Full accelerator program (all live sessions), community/accountability group access.

Tier 2 — Guided: Everything in Tier 1, plus 1:1 audit and skills assessment, resume/LinkedIn optimization, free headshot and profile review, access to 3 mock interview sessions, and an introduction to the Migrant Smart recruiter network.

Tier 3 — Concierge: Everything in Tier 2, plus branding and positioning for LinkedIn, priority mentor matching, job application and placement support, 9 mock interview sessions, and priority access to opportunities in the referral network.

5. Program Structure — 6 Weeks, Maximum Value

Condensed from the original 8-week draft and re-focused entirely on advancement (no first-job-search content, since this ICP is already employed). Every week earns its place.

Week 1 — Diagnose & Design - Pre-work: online career audit / self-assessment - In-class: career audit, goal mapping (promotion vs. lateral move vs. new employer), baseline resume/LinkedIn review

Week 2 — Personal Brand & Visibility - Resume/LinkedIn optimization sprint (positioned for advancement, not just search) - Personal brand narrative development (guest speaker) - How to be visible without over-promoting yourself — Canadian workplace culture briefing

Week 3 — Build Credibility & Trust - The framework for building trust and credibility inside a Canadian organization - Communication strategy that wins buy-in - Handling difficult situations (live Q&A)

Week 4 — Network Strategically - Internal networking: finding sponsors and allies inside your own organization - External networking: informational interviews, cold outreach (templates + live practice) - Mentor matching finalized; accountability pods (groups of 4-6) launched

Week 5 — Interview & Negotiate - Mock interviews and promotion-conversation role-play - STAR method / storytelling for performance reviews and interviews - Salary and promotion negotiation role-play, offer evaluation framework

Week 6 — Execution & Sustained Growth - Personal 90-day action plan (capstone) - Long-term visibility and advancement strategy — what to do after the program ends - Community transition: ongoing accountability pod structure, mentor relationship continuation

6. Success Metrics

- 80% attendance rate across all sessions
- 40% active participation in the community group
- 70% of participants purchase additional/upsell services
- Career Clinic NPS of 85%+
- **% of Tier 2/3 participants who report a promotion, raise, or new role within 6 months of completion** — track this via a structured 90-day and 6-month follow-up survey, built into the program from day one. Use it internally to prove the program works and to guide improvements. If it's ever published externally, frame it as reported outcomes among past participants ("X% of participants reported a promotion within 6 months") — never as an expected or typical result, and never in a way that reads as a promise to future participants.

7. Operations Checklist

- Intake process: registration (Luma), payment collection, post-signup email sequence, community onboarding, support/FAQ process
- Recruit and structure a volunteer bench for resume review and workshop facilitation
- Recruit mentors/guest speakers; decide compensation structure now (paid vs. exposure/network access)
- Build employer/recruiter relationships; consider a placement-commission structure for advancement outcomes sourced through the network
- Build curriculum materials: slide decks, resource packs, templates/scripts for networking and negotiation
- Secure a venue (Bow Valley College, corporate partners e.g. EY, co-working spaces)
- Build the 90-day / 6-month outcome survey now, so it's ready to deploy the moment Week 6 ends

8. Marketing Strategy

Messaging pillar: "You got the job. Now what?" — speak directly to people who are employed but stuck, not to job seekers. This distinguishes the program from every free settlement service by name.

Pre-clinic (70% direct outreach / 30% social): - Direct outreach: community networks, cultural associations, employee resource groups inside companies - B2B angle: pitch this as an internal workshop offering to organizations — talent retention is expensive, and this program can be framed as a retention tool for their immigrant employees, not just a consumer product - Credibility content: teach one real, useful framework for free before asking for the sale (e.g., "how to build trust in your first 90 days" style posts)

Post-clinic (content engine): - Short clips from live sessions under two pillars: "*Things no one tells you*" (advancement/insider knowledge) and "*The frameworks for building your case for advancement*" - 6-month outcome stories (promotions, raises, new roles), where participants choose to share them, make strong social proof — build the collection process in from week 1, and present them as individual stories

("here's what happened for [name]"), not as a projected or typical outcome

Language guardrails for social, LinkedIn, and newsletter copy:

Instead of (implies a guarantee)	Use (accurate, still compelling)
"Get promoted in 6 weeks"	"Build your case for advancement in 6 weeks"
"We'll get you seen and paid more"	"Learn the systems for being seen and valued at work"
"This program gets you promoted"	"This program teaches what promoted people actually do"
"Guaranteed results" / "Proven to work"	"Built from what's worked for past participants" (only if backed by real data)
Testimonial framed as the expected outcome	Testimonial framed as one person's story, with context

Reference table to be shared with the Social Media Manager and LinkedIn/Newsletter lead before copy production begins.

Pre-launch conversion event: Community BBQ

In-person trust-building for a decision this personal converts better than any ad. This is the first cohort, so there are no Career Clinic testimonials yet — the event should lean on mentor/recruiter credibility and direct conversation, not borrowed or hypothetical outcomes.

- **Format:** casual BBQ, 90–120 minutes, capped at 30–50 attendees for quality of conversation over headcount
 - Food and mingling (30 min)
 - Problem-framing talk (15–20 min): the data and the "employed but stuck" framing from Section 3
 - Fireside chat (20–30 min) with 1–2 mentors or recruiters from the network on what actually moves someone toward advancement
 - Live Q&A (15 min)
 - Soft CTA: attendee-only early-bird code, QR code to the landing page, sign-up sheet for anyone who wants a 1:1 follow-up call
- **Venue:** partner with a credible local organization (e.g., Bow Valley College, EY, a cultural association) to reduce cost and add trust
- **Timing:** Saturday, August 22 — after the landing page is live and early-bird registration is open, with enough runway before the final registration push to convert warm leads
- **Follow-up:** same-day thank-you email plus an early-bird deadline reminder; in-person interest cools quickly without prompt follow-up
- **Owners:** PM (venue and logistics), Social Media Manager + LinkedIn/Newsletter lead (event promotion and invites), founder (talk and mentor coordination)

9. Implementation Plan — Launch by September 12

Launch date: **September 12**. Current date: **July 28** — a 7-week runway. Team: Project Manager (landing page + ops), Social Media Manager, and LinkedIn/Newsletter lead.

Week	Dates	Focus	Owner(s)
1	Jul 28 – Aug 3	Finalize ICP, messaging, and pricing per tier. Brief full team on this doc. Outline curriculum decks. Draft landing page copy and structure.	You (positioning) + PM (landing page brief)
2	Aug 4 – Aug 10	Landing page in build. Start	PM (landing page, Luma),

		mentor/guest speaker outreach. Set up Luma event + payment flow. Begin “credibility post” content series (teaser phase, no registration ask yet).	LinkedIn/Newsletter lead (content series), Social Media Manager (teaser calendar)
3	Aug 11 – Aug 17	Landing page live. Open early-bird registration. Waitlist campaign goes live across social + LinkedIn + newsletter. Recruit volunteer resume reviewers. Send Community BBQ invites.	PM (site live, registration tracking), Social Media Manager + LinkedIn lead (launch push + BBQ invites)
4	Aug 18 – Aug 24	Full marketing push (organic + any paid). Confirm mentors/speakers and lock their session dates. Finalize slide decks and resource packs. Secure venue for cohort sessions. Host Community BBQ (Sat, Aug 22) — invites out by Aug 11, day-of logistics and mentor coordination confirmed by Aug 18.	Social Media Manager (paid/organic push + event promotion), You (mentor confirmations + event talk), PM (venue for both cohort sessions and BBQ), LinkedIn/Newsletter lead (event invites)
5	Aug 25 – Aug 31	Mid-campaign push — urgency messaging (“early-bird closes soon”). B2B outreach to organizations for the retention-tool angle. Dry-run tech/logistics for Week 1 session.	Social Media Manager + LinkedIn lead (urgency campaign), You (B2B outreach)
6	Sep 1 – Sep 7	Final registration push, early-bird deadline. Send onboarding sequence to confirmed registrants. Finalize accountability pod groupings and mentor matches. Set up community (WhatsApp/MS Community).	PM (onboarding emails, pod setup), You + team (final registration push)
7	Sep 8 – Sep 11	Final logistics check: facilitator run-through, tech check, welcome packet sent. Confirm Week 1 session details with all registrants.	PM (logistics), You (facilitator readiness)
Launch	Sep 12	Week 1 — Diagnose & Design kicks off.	Full team live

Critical path items for Week 1: 1. Final pricing per tier — required before landing page and Luma setup can be completed. 2. Mentor/speaker outreach list — longest lead time in the plan; outreach should begin immediately.